

the open-ended responses about money were directly related to career and a lot of career responses mentioned feeling purpose or enjoying their career. We know that relationships, job security, self-worth, and fulfillment are all important thanks to Maslow's hierarchy of needs. But what does each of these 4 F's mean for our finances?

Just like the survey's conclusion, **family** is also what we hear from our listeners as what they value most. And it's what we value most in our lives too! More than anything, we want more time and deeper relationships with our partners, kids, siblings, and parents. Well, some parents more than others. Relationships are so vital to maintaining values-based spending that we've devoted a whole chapter to them later in the book. That's because, when healthy, relationships with family and friends keep us motivated. They're also the best way to meet our connection and intimacy needs and our higher needs, like self-esteem and respect. When unhealthy, they can deplete these needs as fast as they fill them. When it comes to money, we think there's no better place to spend than on family. Whether that's on a vacation to spend quality time or simply buying a gratuitous number of monster truck toys to incentivize a three-year-old's potty-training efforts. We've also both joyfully helped family members financially in times of need. In addition to the money we'd gladly spend, there are expenses for our family that aren't as fun but that we are responsible for, like extra equipment and tournaments for a child who's exceptionally good at sports or providing financial support for a parent who's ill. Because there are so many expenses that are good and necessary, sometimes we can rationalize that all expenses for our family are good or necessary. I know I've paid for lessons my kids didn't want and dinners my husband didn't enjoy because I thought that's what I had to do to be a good mom and wife. And nowhere are financial boundary lines crossed more than within families where pressure and coercion can influence spending. A huge part of spending in alignment with your values will be figuring out the difference between the expenses you'll gladly pay for your family and the ones you need to build boundaries to avoid.

Friends are our community outside of family, and at times our chosen family. Lack of time, past traumas like broken trust, and an ever-dividing country have made finding friends difficult, but friendship remains at the core of our being. Another Pew Research Center survey found that 69 percent of Americans have three or more close friends⁴ and 38 percent of